

AFTER THE RELEASE · 2 OF 2

Should you keep running ads after a release?

A release campaign ends when its payoff window closes. A catalog campaign can run evergreen.

By Benjamin Means · swipe →

THE CURVE

Most hits peak in their first week

Spotify Top 50 tracks only. It says nothing directly about a smaller release.

NEARLY

40%

PEAK ON RELEASE DAY

IN ALL

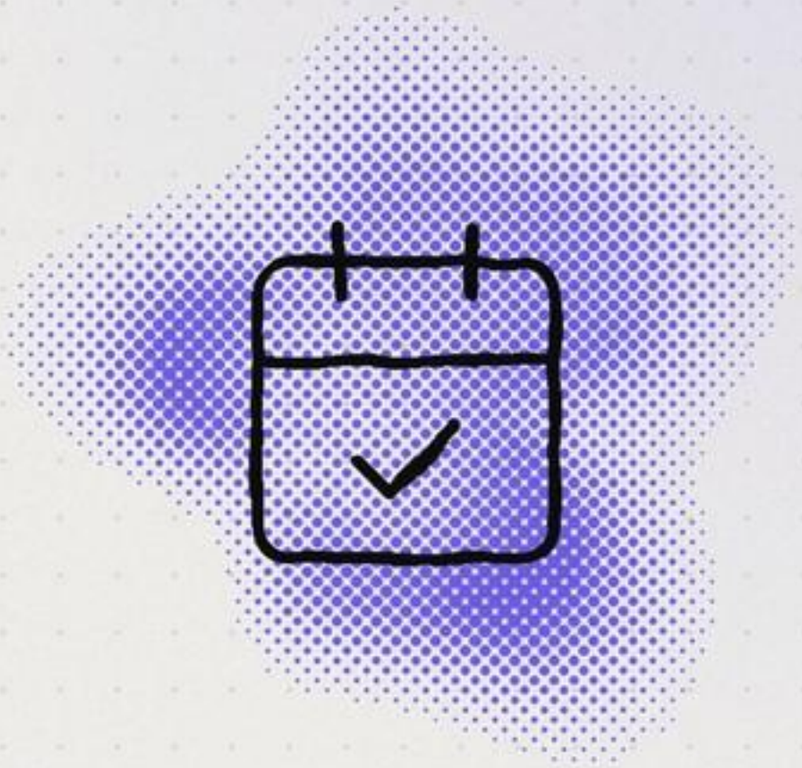
65%

PLATEAU WITHIN A WEEK

Release Radar carries a new song

UP TO 4 WEEKS

Stat Significant on Chartmetric data, 2025 · Spotify for Artists



RELEASE CAMPAIGNS

A release campaign ends on its payoff date

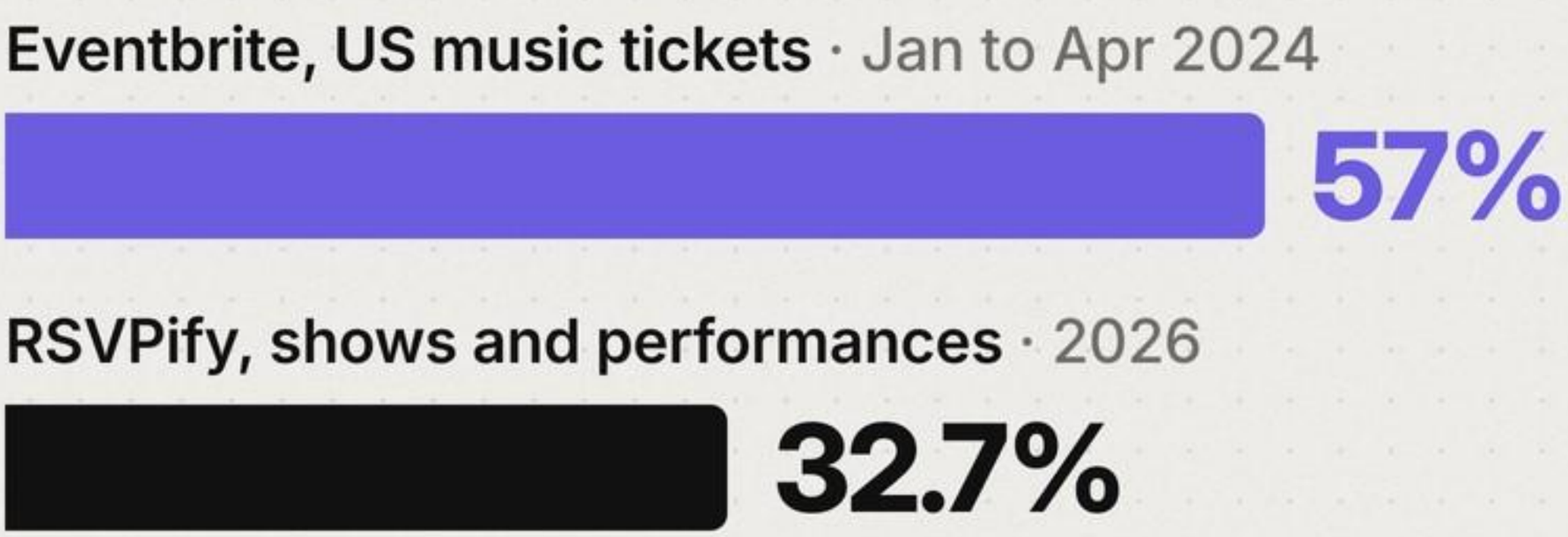
When that window closes, the release campaign should close with it.

Pre-saves	RELEASE WEEK
Tickets	SHOW NIGHT
Merch at shows	THE TOUR
Online merch, pre-orders, drops	YOUR DATE

TICKETS

Ticket sales pile up in the final week

Share of tickets bought a week or less before the show



Keep ticket ads running through that week

THEN STOP

Eventbrite 2024 Music Edit via Pollstar · RSVPify 2026 platform data

EVERGREEN

Catalog is most of the market

US on-demand audio streams in 2025, roughly 1.4 trillion. Evergreen fits a song that has already proven itself.



About 3 in 4 older than 18 months

CATALOG

334.0 billion current music

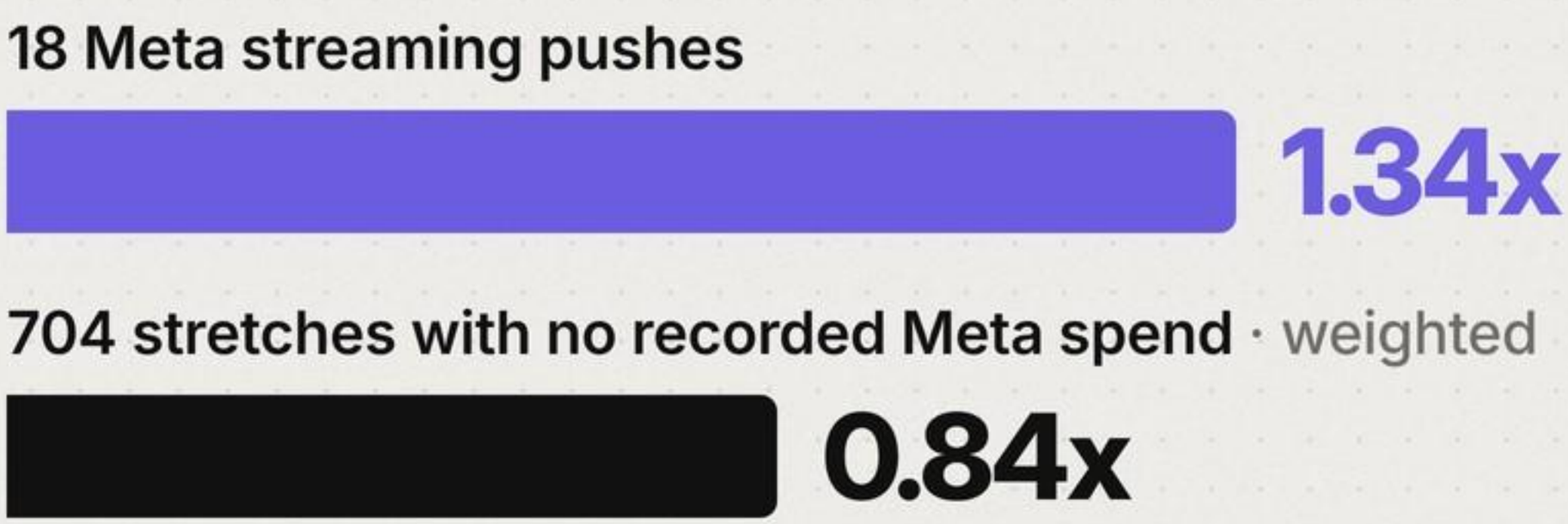
CURRENT

Luminate 2025 Year-End Report via Variety, Jan 2026

OUR DATA

Pushes came out ahead for 3 of 4 artists

Average daily streams vs the prior 28-day average, median



Trust the direction more than the size

NO HOLDOUT

MeansMGMT S4A re-audit, 2026-09-22 · 4 of 9 artists · Meta spend only, anonymized

WHEN TO STOP

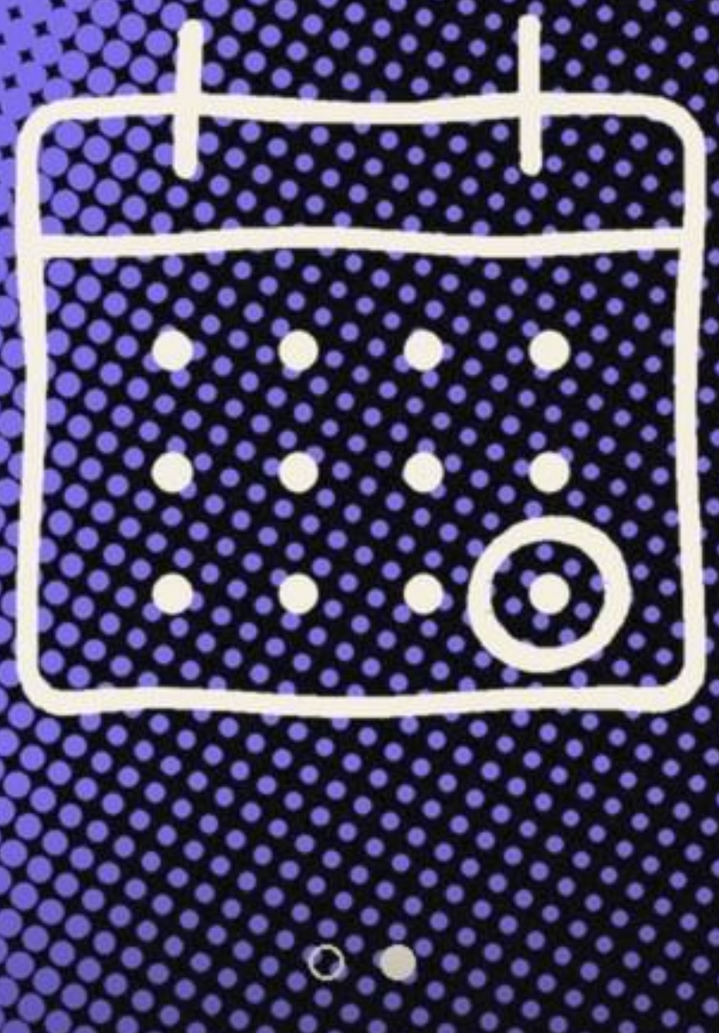
When to stop either one

1. **A release campaign stops on its date**
   After that, the payoff has already happened.

2. **Agree on the evergreen goal first**
   Also agree on what missing it looks like.

3. **One weak window isn’t a stop signal**
   A third of our 32 pushes came in under 1.0x against the 28 days before.

4. **Stop when it keeps missing**
   A song that keeps coming in under its own baseline has stopped being evergreen.



OUR READ

Stop release ads on their payoff date.

A catalog song can keep running while it beats the artist's own baseline.

Full post at meansmgmt.com